TEAM CAPLET · TEAM BRIEF · THURSDAY 1 OCTOBER 2026

Where we are, and what we do this week

From a full review of our repo on 30 Sep. Prepared with Claude Code (AI) for our planning only: not text for any submission, and it goes in our AI-use log.

The bottom line

- **Our strategy is strong, and the numbers check out.** Root-and-Branch was re-checked from scratch against official U.S. Treasury data, and every key number matched.
- **The biggest risks are no longer the maths.** They are authorship (Wharton's AI rules), our public GitHub repo, too much complexity, and Friday-night logistics.
- **This week:** read the Week-One email, settle three votes on Thursday, and place our first trades on Friday night.
- **All six of us must be able to explain the plan in our own words.** The semifinal is a live presentation, and every member has to take part.

Our plan in six steps (Root-and-Branch)

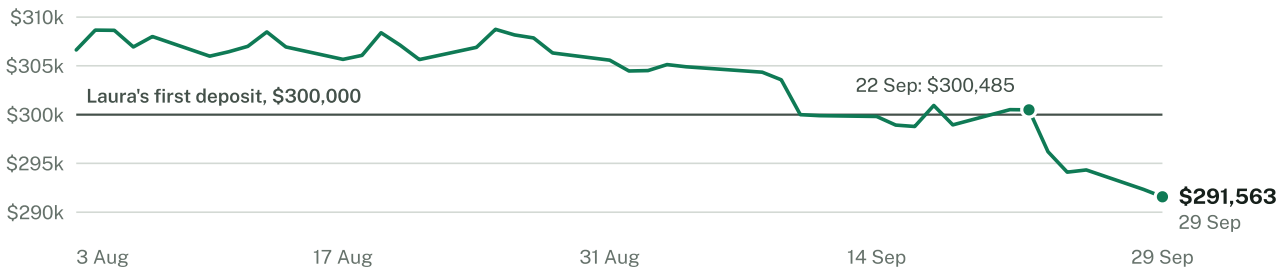
1. **January 2027, the roots.** Laura's $300,000 buys ten dated U.S. Treasury holdings, one ending just before each $50,000 payment (2033–2042). In WInS: iShares iBonds funds IBTM–IBTR for 2033–2037, and five Treasury bonds for 2038–2042.
2. **If yields fall first** and the ten cost more than $300,000 in January, her 2028 deposit completes them first.
3. **January 2028, the floor.** Most of the $150,000 buys Treasuries that repay about $150,000 in late 2032: the least she will give the facility.
4. **The branch.** The rest (about $41,000) goes into one world stock fund (VT), held to 2033.
5. **2031, co-sponsors.** She announces a range: the floor (quoted rounded down, about $145,000) up to the floor plus half the fund's value then (about $175,000 on today's projection).
6. **2033.** She gives the floor plus half the fund, capped at the announced top, so the gift cannot land outside the range. The other half stays with her as a cushion. The ten holdings become the operating reserve and pay out one a year.

Our WInS “Portfolio tab” book is this plan on 2 January 2028, scaled to $300,000: about 66% dated Treasuries, 24% floor (inside IBTM), 9% VT and 1% cash.

Numbers we checked independently

What	Result
Cost of the ten payments, 28 Sep Treasury curve	$289,119 (matches our kit to the dollar)
Cost on 1 Jan 2027 at today's yields	about $292,000, leaving about $8,000 spare
Chance yields fall enough by January that the 2028 deposit must help	about 1 in 3
The same ladder priced at 2020 yields	about $460,000
Typical top of the 2031 range	about $175,000
Moving $25,000 of the floor into stocks	+$2,400 typically; −$9,500 in a 1-in-20 bad market

Why January yields matter. What the ten payments would cost on 1 Jan 2027, priced on each day's official Treasury curve. Above the line, $300,000 is not enough and the 2028 deposit has to help. They have fitted only since mid-September.



Source: home.treasury.gov daily par yield curves (fetched 30 Sep 2026), independent pricer.

This week

Before Thursday's meeting: one person, read-only login, place nothing

- [ ] Read the Week-One email and the logged-in Trading Details page: any minimum trading-activity rule or first-trade deadline? (The official FAQ says a rule exists but does not define it.)
- [ ] Open an order screen without submitting: which order types exist (limit? day orders?), and how is bond quantity entered?
- [ ] Copy the full bond drop-down (43 Treasuries, with coupon and maturity).

Thursday meeting: decide, and write it down

1. We adopt Root-and-Branch **as a team**. Record who agreed and why, in our own words. It is our decision, not the AI's.
2. **Book:** the Portfolio tab (recommended, because it shows all three parts of the plan) or Book L (ladder only).
3. **Swap rule:** buy a listed low-coupon alternate only if it passes its price check on Friday; otherwise buy the planned bond.
4. **Note writers:** who writes each WInS note (our own words, 300 characters at most, cannot be edited later).
5. **Friday roles, each with a backup:** trader, checker, note keeper, recorder, timekeeper. If the refresh script cannot run, trade from `rab/trades/tickets.md` using its stop rules.
6. **Timing:** limit orders placed before bed (if WInS allows them) or trading from 12:30 to 1:30 am; VT on Friday or on Tue 6 Oct at 1:30 am.

Friday-night rules

- Read the name WInS shows before every order. **IBTN is INSCORP Inc, not an iBond.**
- Never pay above the ticket's max price. Stop if the Preview total is outside the ticket's band (a 10x gap means the bond unit is wrong).
- Never re-enter a pending order. Never sell anything on the day it was bought.
- After each order, copy the saved note back from Order History and check that nothing was cut off.

Admin

- **Roster by Fri 9 Oct (Sat 10 Oct, 8 am Sydney):** full names, emails, birthdays, graduation years, team name and school details. Members are locked once it is submitted.
- **School documentation:** ask the school for its letter now. It is due with the Final Report.

Four risks, and what we do about each

1. Authorship: this one could get us dismissed.
The IPS draft in our Google Doc is an AI-written exemplar. Wharton's rules say AI-generated work may not be submitted as your own, and plagiarism is grounds for dismissal.
What we do: We write the IPS ourselves, from a blank page, using the list of what it must cover rather than the exemplar's sentences. The same goes for WInS notes and reflections. We don't use the ready-made AI disclosure in `docs/AI_USE.md` (it is inaccurate), and our Final Report says plainly how we used AI.

2. Our repo is public.
Anyone can read our full plan and the example notes. One file contains a teammate's school email, and the repo's history still holds our WInS username. Another team could copy us, and lookalike submissions hurt both teams.
What we do: Ray makes the repo private (Settings, General, Change visibility). A strong WInS password that is never sent by message. The IPS Doc and the team Sheet set to Restricted sharing.

3. Complexity.
About 45,000 lines of code and 700,000 words of research sit behind roughly 1,000 words of submissions. Last year's lesson was that our packaging was too complex for the idea.
What we do: No new research unless a decision needs it. Each of us owns one part of the plan and can explain it in three sentences.

4. Friday logistics.
Unread Week-One email, unseen order screen, a refresh script that runs on one laptop, and trading at 12:30 am.
What we do: The Thursday read-only login, a backup for every role, and limit orders if WInS offers them.

Questions a judge will ask, and our answers

Question	Our answer
"91% Treasuries? Laura says she takes thoughtful risks."	Her payments are fixed dollar amounts, so dollar bonds match them, and they use about $290,000 of her first $300,000. Only the 2028 money is free. Moving $25,000 of the floor into stocks adds about $2,400 typically and loses about $9,500 in a bad market.
"Your own model says all-Treasuries gives the facility more. Why hold stocks?"	That comparison gives the whole pot to the facility, while we keep half the fund for Laura. The fund is her flexibility money: it has the longest horizon, it is the only part that can keep up with rising costs, and it is the balance she asked for.
"Do the payments really depend only on the U.S. government?"	Mostly. About 85% of each payment is owed outright by the government; the rest depends on reinvesting interest. If rates sat at 2% for years, the ten would deliver about $466,000 of $500,000, so we name who covers a shortfall (our decision by 26 Oct).
"100% confidence in the range sounds like a trick."	It is by design: the bottom is bonds she already owns, and the top is a cap she sets. The gift lands at or near the top about 3 times in 4.
"What if her 2028 deposit never arrives?"	The payments still happen: at today's yields the 2027 deposit covers all ten. A stock-heavy plan missed payments in about 4 cases in 10 without it.
"The residency is in Taiwan."	The gift is in U.S. dollars and the costs are in Taiwan dollars. We say so, and we name who carries that risk.

The three deliverables

Trading Notes Analysis (due Fri 23 Oct; aim for Thu 22). Three notes copied exactly from WInS, each with a reflection of 100 words or fewer. Candidates: *tested* (the ladder against $300,000: it did not fit on 22 Sep, and did a week later), *refined* (we switched from bond ETFs to one dated holding per payment, because most of TLH's bonds mature after Laura's last payment in 2042), and *supported* (VT, the growth part).

IPS (due Fri 6 Nov, which is Sat 7 Nov 9 am Sydney; trading freezes an hour earlier). A 50-word pitch and 500 words, Times New Roman 12, double-spaced, no charts or citations. Settle first: our definition of "high certainty", who covers a shortfall, how the floor is defined, and who pays costs.

Final Report (instructions 9 Nov; due 4 Dec). Also needs: our co-sponsor text (we write it), why a credible lead gift matters (seed-money research such as List & Lucking-Reiley, 2002), currency, inflation, our team story (start a short journal now) and an honest AI disclosure.

Own the numbers

Rebuild these five in our own Sheet, so the numbers in the Final Report are ours:

1. the ladder cost from treasury.gov yields
2. the floor's cost in January 2028
3. the top of the 2031 range
4. a bad-case gift (the fund falls 40%)
5. the floor trade-off ($25,000 of floor into stocks)

Read next

`rab/trades/friday_checklist.md`, `rab/trades/tickets.md`, `rab/decisions/D7_wins_book.md`, `rab/trades/notes.md` (the briefs, not the example wording), `rab/decisions/D_certainty_definition.md`. Ignore `decisions/`, `deliverables/`, `MISSION.md` and the old Strategy Brief PDFs: they describe earlier plans.

Key dates (Sydney time)

Fri 2 Oct, 9 pm	Refresh the tickets from live prices
Fri 2 Oct, 10:30 pm	U.S. jobs report: prices can jump
Sat 3 Oct, 12:30 am	Trades (or limit orders placed earlier)
Tue 6 Oct, 1:30 am	VT, unless it went in on Friday
Sat 10 Oct, 8 am	**Roster due**
Thu 15 Oct, 7 am	October check (no trade is a valid result)
Sat 24 Oct, 8 am	**Trading Notes Analysis due**
Sat 7 Nov, 8 am	Trading ends; portfolio frozen
Sat 7 Nov, 9 am	**IPS due**
Sat 5 Dec, 9 am	**Final Report and school letter due**

Sydney moves to daylight time on Sun 4 Oct, and the U.S. on Sun 1 Nov.